Q In what way does Cloud Foundry ease working with cloud applications for DevOps?

The Cloud Foundry architecture is actually two different 'platforms'. At the lowest level is Cloud Foundry BOSH, which is responsible for infrastructure abstraction/automation, distributed system release management and platform health management. Above that is the Cloud Foundry Runtime, which is focused on serving the application developers' needs. The two layers work together to provide a highly automated operational experience, very frequently achieving operator-to-application ratios of 1:1000.

Q How does the container-based platform make application development easy for developers?

The design and evolution of the Cloud Foundry Runtime platform is highly focused on the DX (developer experience). While the Cloud Foundry Runtime does make use of containers within the architecture (in fact, Cloud Foundry's use of container technology predates Docker by years), these are not the focus of a developer's experience with the platform. What makes the Cloud Foundry Runtime so powerful for a developer is its ease of use. Simply 'cf push' your code into the system and let it handle the details of creating, managing and maintaining containers. Similarly, the access to various backing services — like the database, message queues, cache clusters and legacy system APIs — is designed to be exceptionally easy for developers. Overall, Cloud Foundry makes application development easier by eliminating a massive amount of the friction that is typically generated when shipping the code to production.

Q What are the major roadblocks currently faced when developing container-based applications using Cloud Foundry?

There are very few roadblocks for developers who use Cloud Foundry, but there are certainly areas where developers need to adjust older ways of thinking about how to best design the architecture of an application. The best architecture for an application being deployed to Cloud Foundry can be described as 'microservices', including choices like each service being independently versioned and deployed. While the microservices architecture may be new for a developer, it is certainly not a roadblock. In fact, even without fully embracing the microservices architecture, a developer can get significant value from deploying to the Cloud Foundry Runtime.

> *"The Cloud Foundry Foundation exists to steward the massive open source development efforts that have built the Cloud Foundry as open source software as well as to enable its adoption globally."*

Q Microsoft recently joined the Cloud Foundry Foundation, while Google has been on board since a long time. By when can you expect Amazon to become a key member of the community?

We think that the community and Amazon can benefit greatly by the latter becoming a part of Cloud Foundry. That said, it is important to note that Amazon Web Services (AWS) is already very well integrated into the Cloud Foundry platform, and is frequently being used as the underlying Infrastructure-as-a-Service (IaaS) that Cloud Foundry is deployed on.

Q How do you view Microsoft's decision on joining the non-profit organisation?

Microsoft has long been a member of the Cloud Foundry community, so the decision to join the Cloud Foundry Foundation represents a formalisation of its corporate support for the project. We are very happy that the company has chosen to take this step, and we are already starting to see the impact of this move on the project through increased engagement.

Q Is there any specific plan to encourage IT decision makers at enterprises to deploy Microsoft's Azure?

The Cloud Foundry Foundation is a vendor-neutral industry association. Therefore, we do not recommend any specific vendor over another. Our goal is to help all vendors integrate well into the Cloud Foundry software, community and market for the purpose of ensuring that the users and customers have a wide range of options for any particular service they may need, including infrastructure, databases, professional services and training.

Q As VMware originally conceived the Cloud Foundry platform back in 2009, how actively does the company now participate in the community?

Cloud Foundry was initially created at VMware, but the platform was transferred to Pivotal Software when it was spun out of VMware and EMC. When the Cloud Foundry Foundation was formed to support the expansion of the ecosystem and contributing community, VMware was a founding Platinum member. VMware remains heavily engaged in the Cloud Foundry Foundation in many ways, from providing engineering talent within the projects to supporting many of our other initiatives. It is a key member of the community.

Q What are the key points an enterprise needs to consider before opting for a cloud solution?

There are two key areas for consideration, based on how I categorise the various services offered by each of the leading cloud vendors, including